

HOUSE No. 715

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Joshua Tarsky

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act relative to phone-free schools.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Joshua Tarsky</i>	<i>13th Norfolk</i>	<i>1/9/2025</i>
<i>Richard G. Wells, Jr.</i>	<i>7th Norfolk</i>	<i>6/30/2025</i>
<i>Danillo A. Sena</i>	<i>37th Middlesex</i>	<i>7/14/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 715

By Representative Tarsky of Needham, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 715) of Joshua Tarsky for legislation to prohibit the use of personal electronic devices by students during the school day. Education.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act relative to phone-free schools.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Chapter 71 of the General Laws is hereby amended by adding the following section:-

2 Section 102. (a) For the purposes of this section, the following terms shall, unless the
3 context clearly requires otherwise, have the following meanings:-

4 “Personal electronic device”, a cell telephone, tablet, smart watch, computer or other
5 portable electronic device capable of voice communication, text messaging or internet access.

6 “Pouch system”, a system in which access to a personal electronic device is restricted
7 through storing the device in a pouch, which can be locked or unlocked at certain times and
8 locations by the school’s teaching or administrative staff.

9 (b) Each school district shall implement a pouch system to prohibit the use of personal
10 electronic devices by students during the school day.

11 (c) Each school district shall implement a policy for the use of the pouch system. The
12 policy shall permit the use of personal electronic devices if authorized by teaching or
13 administrative staff. The policy shall require that students secure their personal electronic
14 devices in a pouch upon entrance to the school and that each pouch is unlocked at the end of the
15 school day.

16 (c) Annually, the school district shall submit its policies to the department for review and
17 approval. The department shall promulgate regulations, pursuant to chapter 30A, which shall
18 include minimum requirements for the school districts' policies.